

## iuVCR

### Good, but not the best

● iuVCR's friendly and simple interface allows you to capture video in any format, frame size and duration. At the same time, because of its integration with Windows scheduler, it starts and stops recording automatically.

It is strategically made—parameters such as 'Max file size' and 'Max file time', ensure that the file size does not exceed that of the recording media, or eat up the entire free space. These parameters also help you avoid the maximum size limitation of file systems such as FAT32, which restrict the file size to 4 GB. You can even specify partitions across which to span the recording. This leads to efficient disk space usage.

By default, iuVCR captures video in the AVI format using either the huffyuv compressor, or the PICVideo MJPEG compressor. You need to install the necessary encoder, if you wish to record in Microsoft Windows Media Format. The recording options also provide control over audio-video synchronisation. To enhance image quality as it gets captured, create filters within the application. There is also support for additional plug-ins to process real-time video streams.

A natty feature is the one-touch button that captures your favourite television moments. Unable to snap that shot at the right time? Capture the entire live video in a series of bmp files, and later choose the one you need. The Info tab shows you useful real-time statistics such as the number of frames recorded or



Use the Capture Format settings to modify colour format, frame size and frame rate

skipped, the output file size, free drive space and the current CPU usage.

Lastly, a simple presets manager allows you to set and save all the current program settings under a unique name. You can use this name in the scheduler, or when starting iuVCR with command-line parameters.

While it did well in the performance department, iuVCR lacked features such as real-time TV functionality to pause and resume the TV signal at will. Thus, it did not differentiate itself from the rest of the products in the market.

**Price:** US\$ 27.50

**Web site:** [www.iulabs.com](http://www.iulabs.com)

- + Span the video capture across drives; apply filters in real-time
- Lacks real-time TV functionality

## PowerVCR II Standard Version

### Truly professional

Armed with top-of-the-line features such as time-shifting and instant replay, PowerVCR II makes TV-viewing enjoyable. With the time-shifting feature, you need not wait for a commercial to answer nature's call. Use the Instant Replay button to watch the fall of wickets in a cricket match. The instant replay interval could be anywhere between 10 to 70 minutes.

PowerVCR II is very user-friendly—a small window pops up after its installation, to help you set up the channels. It provides pre-defined profiles—MPEG-2 Excellent, MPEG-2 Superior, MPEG-2 Good and MPEG-2 Average—to capture video. It has similar options for MPEG-1 too. VCD profiles such as VCD NTSC, VCD PAL and VCD Film are also available. It can convert the captured video from, or to, any of these formats, without the need for a third-party converter. It also has controls to tweak image brightness, hue, etc, while recording. The button on the TV-controls panel lets you snap a funky TV visual. An image file is automatically created in a default folder. You can also change the storage folder location.

Another useful feature is the automatic naming of files. Were it not for this, accidental double-clicks on the Record button would have overwritten the current recording session in



Setting up the audio-video source, as well as its format, is the most important task in PowerVCR II

the preceding file.

Apart from the all-important inbuilt scheduler, a significant feature present is Stop Condition, that stops the recording after a time interval that you define.

Thus, a mélange of features, topped with great functionality, makes PowerVCR II the winner in this category.

**Price:** US\$ 49.95

**Web site:** <http://www.gocyberlink.com/english/index.jsp>

- + Live-TV options; wide variety of formats to capture video
- A drab time-based stop condition

